SHOWCASE

CUDA Jetpack

The CUDA jetpack is an underwater jetpack, one that was 3D printed at that. The jetpack was created by Archie O'Brien of U.K's Loughborough University for his final year project in his Product Design class. It took him several months to put the jetpack together and he hopes to eventually sell the CUDA jetpack at around $6000.

O'Brien drew inspiration for the CUDA jetpack from the SEABOB, which is a handheld aqua scooter, a hybrid jet-ski and foam float. However, he wasn't too keen on the $17,000 price tag. Thanks to 3D printing though, he thought he could maybe build his own. And so began his research. For the aesthetics, he took inspiration from the designs of high-end cars from the likes of Lamborghini, Aston Martin and Mclaren.

As for the transition from hand-held, like the SEABOB was, to hands-free, O'Brien said making the experience hands-free is a lot better for many reasons, and it also feels more akin to flying, something he's always wanted to do.

The CUDA Jetpack is still in its early stages, but Archie O'Brien is targeting sometime in 2019 for the first CUDA production models to come out.

Vincross Robo-Plant

Many people keep plants at home, and those who do, know that taking care of them is not always as easy as simply watering them every now and then. Certain plants have very specific conditions that need to be met in order for them to survive. This could be various things from sunlight, to water, temperature, moisture etc. Normally, it's very difficult to find a spot in the house that gets adequate amounts of sunlight throughout the day. But what if your plant could make its way to the sunlight on its own? Well, there aren't really any plants that can do that (yet), but with a little human help, it's possible.

Chinese entrepreneur Sun Tianqi and his company, Vincross has made a six-legged robot which can carry a potted plant on its back. If you got an image of the Pokemon Bulbasaur in your head, you're not far off! The robot can move the plant towards sunlight when needed and even retreats back into the shade when the plant has had enough. Furthermore, the robot monitors and lets you know when the plant needs to be watered by doing a dance and can even interact with humans.

Oscar the A.I Trash Bin

Autonomous, an office and gaming furniture company, have created an artificially intelligent garbage bin, named Oscar. Now since Oscar has an AI, it's a smart device. So a smart garbage bin if you will.

So what can Oscar do? Well according to Autonomous, Oscar can sort your trash for you, i.e., it can tell what is recyclable and what isn't.

Oscar's image-recognition camera can detect whether or not the trash you've dropped into the bin is recyclable or not. There's two cardboard bins under the mechanism, one for recyclable waste and the other for non-recyclable.

When Oscar is unable to recognise an item, there's an LED that blinks red, which prompts the user to "teach" Oscar the item's classification. This information is stored in an A.I server in the cloud, which in turn is shared with all Oscar units. Of course, since Oscar is a smart device, you will need an outlet and an internet connection, so if you haven't got WiFi, the unit is not going to work.

This is the company's first smart device and they plan to crowdfund Oscar on Kickstarter. The planned price for the smart garbage bin is $1000.